Data: **Carta** · re-visualized for classroom use, attributed per chart

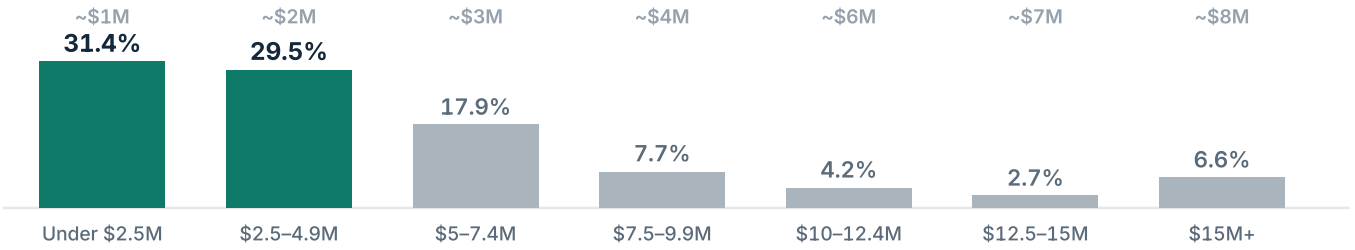
Seed-Stage Benchmarks

What the numbers actually look like at the seed round — how much you raise, what you sell, and what you keep — read against Carta's data on tens of thousands of startups. **Teal = what you keep · clay = what you give up.**

1 — RAISING A SEED ROUND size, dilution & SAFEs

Six in ten seed rounds are under $5M

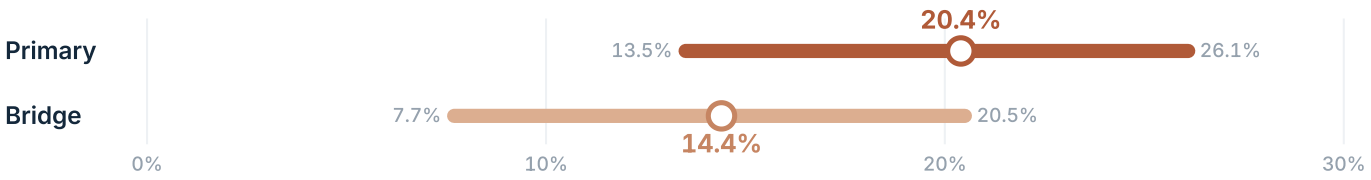
Share of 2025 seed rounds by amount raised — the two **teal** bars are ≈61% of the market. Small figure above each bar ≈ the check a lead writes.



CARTA · 1,429 SEED ROUNDS · US · 2025

A priced seed sells about a fifth of the company

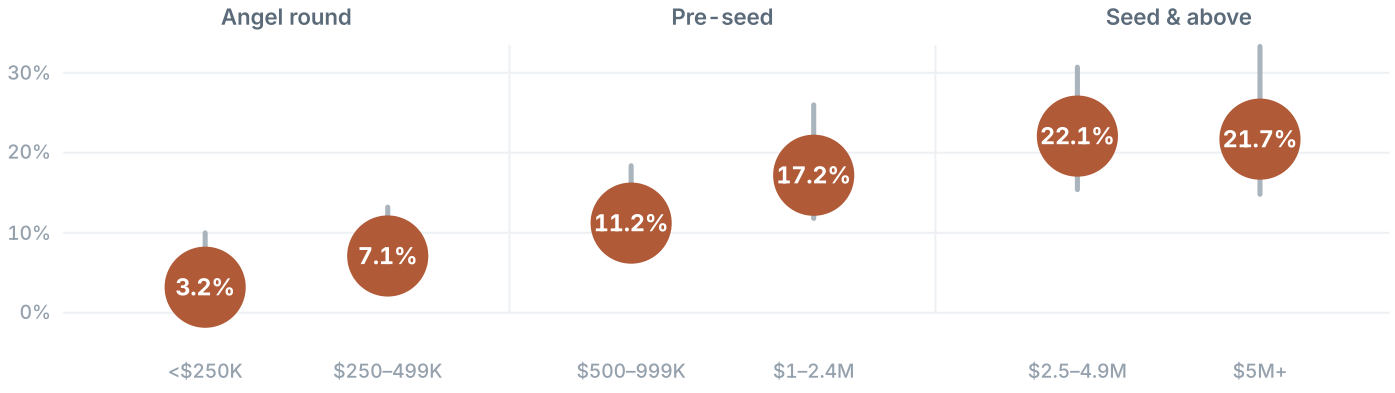
Median % sold to investors — primary rounds vs. bridges. Range spans the 25th–75th percentile; dot is the median.



CARTA · 3,368 PRICED ROUNDS · US · JAN–SEP 2024

The more you raise on a SAFE, the more you give up

Expected dilution in post-money SAFE rounds — **dot = median**, line = middle-50% range. Dilution climbs with every step up in round size.

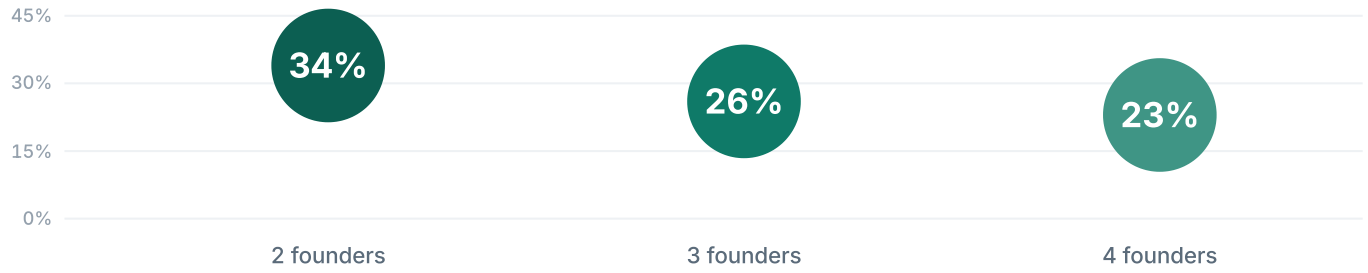


CARTA · 2,414 STARTUPS ON POST-MONEY SAFES · US · 2024

Data © Carta. Used with attribution for classroom instruction.

Fewer founders, a bigger slice each

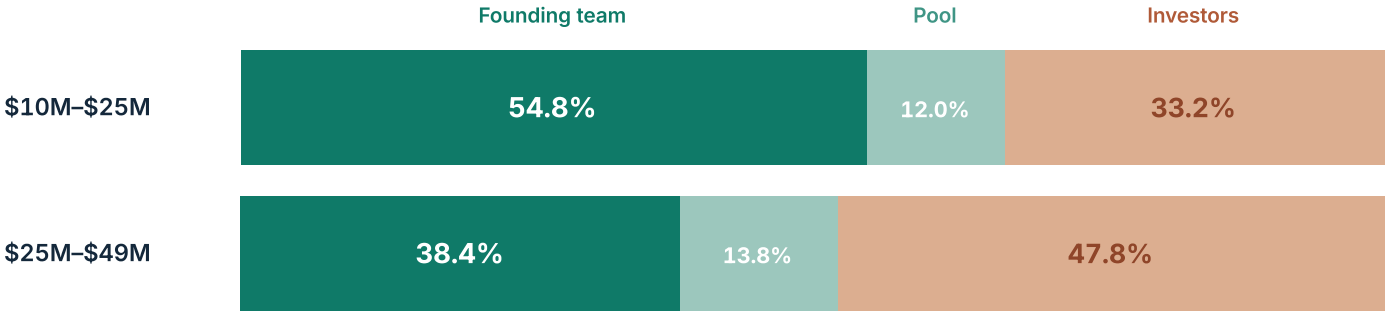
Median equity held per founder at seed, by number of founders — line marks the middle-50% range.



CARTA · 5,857 STARTUPS · MEDIAN PER FOUNDER

Founders' majority fades as valuations rise

Median ownership split at seed / Series A, by post-money valuation. Above ~$25M, investors already hold the largest block.



CARTA · 10,809 US SOFTWARE STARTUPS · ROUNDS RAISED 2019–2024

How each role vests its equity

Most common vesting terms by role in a U.S. startup — the schedule that turns a grant into ownership you actually keep.

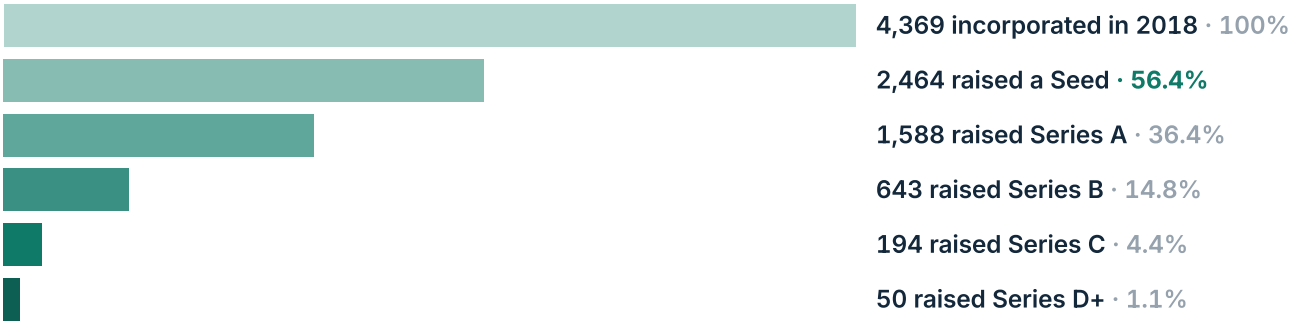
PERSONA / EQUITY TYPE	VESTS OVER	CLIFF?	FREQUENCY
Founders Incentive stock options	4 years	1 year (or none)	Monthly
Advisors Non-qualified stock options	2 years	6 months	Monthly
Independent board Non-qualified stock options	4 years	1 year	Quarterly
Employees Incentive stock options or RSUs	4 years	1 year	Monthly

CARTA · MOST COMMON VALUES ACROSS 500,000+ EQUITYHOLDERS AT CARTA COMPANIES

Data © Carta. Used with attribution for classroom instruction.

Each round, most of the field drops out

The class of 2018, stage by stage — share of the original cohort still advancing. Outcomes as of Jan 2025.



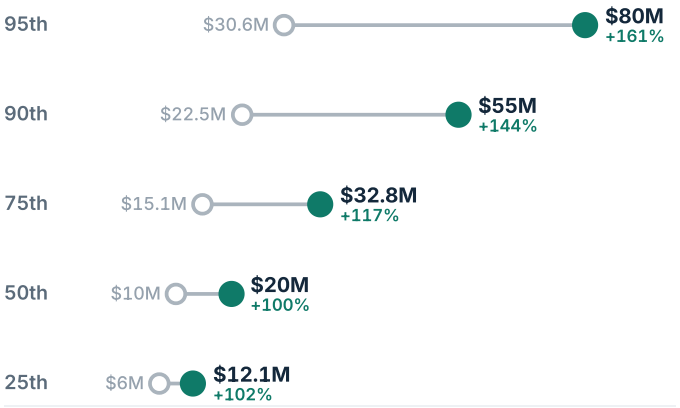
Where they are now:

IPO	M&A	Still live	Closed	Private unicorn
15 · 0.3%	239 · 5.5%	1,408 · 32%	2,707 · 62%	57 · 1.3%

CARTA · 4,369 COMPANIES INCORPORATED 2018 · STATUS AS OF JAN 1, 2025

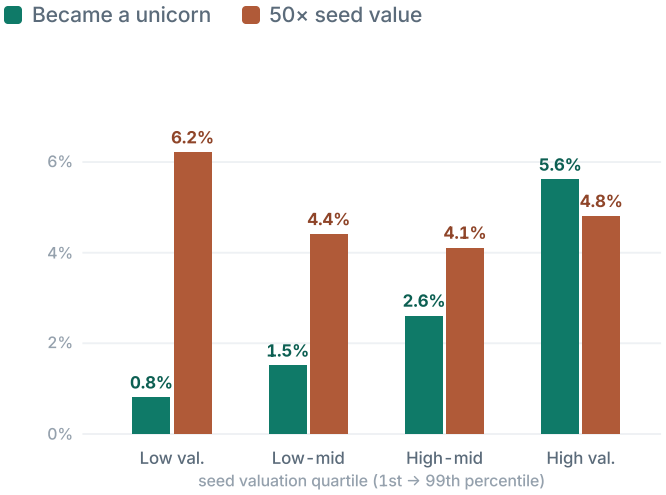
Seed valuations grew fastest at the top

Post-money seed valuation by percentile, 2018 → **2025**. Growth since 2018 in teal.



CARTA · 12,229 US SEED ROUNDS · Q1 2018–Q3 2025

Pricey seeds make more unicorns — cheap ones 50× more often



CARTA · 5,700 US STARTUPS · SEED 2016–2020 · BY HIGHEST VAL

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